



United States
Attorney's Office
Southern District of Ohio



Owner of Halo Home Healthcare sentenced to 4 years in prison for health care fraud, tax crimes

Thursday, April 3, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, Southern District of Ohio

CINCINNATI – Sharon Romaine Ward, 53, formerly of West Chester, was sentenced in U.S. District Court here today to 48 months in prison for fraudulently billing more than \$8.5 million to Medicare, Medicaid and Veterans Affairs health care programs between 2015 and 2021.

When Ward started Halo Home Healthcare in 2015, she concealed her ownership of the company because she had a prior felony conviction in 2013 for passing forged and fraudulent prescriptions for oxycodone and hydrocodone while serving as a nurse practitioner in Warren County. As a result of her conviction, the Department of Health and Human Services Office of Inspector General excluded her from participating in federal health care programs for a minimum period of ten years.

According to court documents, Halo Home Healthcare routinely overbilled federal healthcare programs, charging them for services it did not perform. In one example cited in court documents, Halo continued to bill Medicaid for home health services while the patient was hospitalized. In addition, between 2017 and 2020, Halo hired over 50 employees with significant criminal histories which ordinarily should have excluded them from providing home health services, including one individual who was charged with a quadruple murder while ostensibly working for Halo.

Ward submitted at least 92,770 claims to Medicaid seeking \$8,556,776.58, receiving \$8,403,299.24 between 2016 and 2021. Court documents say she also failed to provide accurate information to her business tax return preparer causing false tax returns to be prepared and filed.

Ward pleaded guilty in June 2024 to health care fraud and making or subscribing a false income tax return.

As part of her sentence, Ward will pay \$8,403,299.24 in restitution to the Ohio Department of Medicaid and \$195,5668.00 to the Department of Veterans Affairs Veterans Healthcare Administration. Ward will

also prepare and file corrected business tax returns with the IRS and pay restitution in the amount of \$81,617 to the IRS.

Kelly A. Norris, Acting United States Attorney for the Southern District of Ohio, announced the sentence imposed today by Senior U.S. District Judge Susan J. Dlott. This case was investigated by the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, the U.S. Secret Service, Internal Revenue Service Criminal Investigation, The U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs Office of Inspector General, and Ohio Attorney General Dave Yost’s Health Care Fraud Section. Assistant United States Attorney Ebunoluwa A. Taiwo is representing the United States in this case.

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